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Exam Class !

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vehicles cannot operate without; these include lithium, cobalt, and "rare earths" (such as neodymium and tantalum, as well as silicon chips, which have already been in scarce since 2020. Secondly, few countries currently have electricity grids that are anywhere near being able to cope with the huge spike in demand for electricity that will accompany any rapid growth in electric vehicle ownership. Without adequate supplies of all the vital components of electric motors and batteries, or power supplies capable of supplying the electricity required to recharge millions of electric batteries every day (as well as supplying the current we need for everything else, such as lighting, heating, and electric devices), the electric car revolution will face insurmountable challenges.

④ Governments and vehicle manufacturers are well aware of these issues, but the consensus among policymakers appears to be that technology will find a way to solve them, as it has in the past. Analysts also expect that changing societal attitudes and environmental awareness will result in a decrease in private car use and a reduction in the number of vehicles on the road. **This prediction** is likely to be correct, but not for the reasons stated; any shortage of essential components will drive up the cost of electric vehicles, and any shortage of battery recharging facilities or capacity will deter people from purchasing electric vehicles, resulting in a decrease in the number of vehicles on the road.

⑤ Ultimately, the success of the shift to electric vehicles will be determined by technological breakthroughs in three areas: the weight of batteries, the amount of power they can provide, and the speed with which they can be recharged... or swapped.

⑥ It may surprise you to learn that electric vehicles are not a new concept; in fact, at the dawn of the automobile age in the late 1800s, America had as many electric automobiles as gasoline-powered cars, and New York's largest cab company employed electric vehicles. To keep their cabs on the road when their batteries ran low, they built up battery terminals in strategic areas where drivers could exchange them for fully recharged ones instead of recharging them, a process that took little longer than refueling with gasoline.

⑦ Thus, rather than battery recharging sites, battery swap stations may be able to alleviate the problem of lengthy recharging periods, which now hinders owners from using their electric vehicles on long trips. However, with today's enormous, hefty batteries, battery swapping is

not a possibility. While the latest generation of Lithium-ion batteries is nearly twice as efficient as batteries used just five years ago, they are still large and heavy. Before batteries can be improved easily, a quantum leap in battery technology is required, allowing batteries to store significantly higher amounts of electricity in much smaller and lighter devices. Teams of outstanding electrical engineers are working on battery technology at universities and private laboratories around the world, and progress is being made quickly....New types of lithium batteries are being developed, but the revolutionary discovery that will change battery architecture has yet to be found.

⑧ In terms of the availability of clean renewable electricity in sufficient amounts to meet demand from all of the world's electric vehicles, progress is already being made in **this area**. Ideally, recharging stations will be self-sufficient, generating their own electricity from solar panels and wind or water turbines and storing it mechanically or in high-powered batteries. The technology already exists, and Beam Global, a California business, recently deployed 30 solar-powered recharge stations in sunny sections of the state.

⑨ So, are people who believe in technology's ability to fix all of our issues realistic or too optimistic? Will other factors such as environmental concerns and the availability of critical components become an impediment? Will all of the world's countries be able to complete the electric vehicle revolution, or will the world's poorer nations fall behind.... once more? For the time being, progress is being made, but can it be sustained? In terms of volume, the electric vehicle revolution is still in its early stages.

Instruction 2: Decide whether each of the following statements are True or False based on the information in the passage, and write the answers in the spaces provided. (1 mark each)

- True 1. Columbia was predicted to have the continent's highest number of cars in 2020. True
- False 2. According to the writer, electric vehicles are a sustainable solution to our transport needs. False
- True 3. Policy makers assure that time will find a solution to the problem of electric car revolution. True
- True 4. There is hardly any country that can provide the demand of electricity electric vehicles require. True

then (1) → batteries
?? this prediction (4) → analysts' expectation
?? this area (8) →
in (1) → progress

6 True 5. The writer is not certain about whether environmental issues and the availability of vital materials impede the transition to electric cars. True

False 6. After three decades, there will not be gasoline cars in the world. False

True 7. The writer forecasts a reduction in the number of personal cars in the future. True

True 8. According to the passage, shortage of essential components may result in a fall in the number of vehicles on the roads. True

True 9. Research on car battery efficiency has almost reached the required level. True

True 10. The concept of electric cars is almost as old as the invention of fuel run cars. True

Instruction 3: For each of the following questions, choose the letter that contains the correct answer, and write the letter of your choice in the spaces provided. (1 mark each)

C 1. The general idea of paragraph 1 is:

A. Tesla is the leading electric vehicle producer.

B. A significant number of countries import electric cars.

3 C C. The transition to electric cars is coming.

D. The price of electric cars is increasing.

D 2. The success of a transition to electric powered vehicles depends on advances in technologies in:

A. the weight of batteries ✓

B. the amount of power batteries can produce ✓

C. the speed at which electric car batteries can be recharged

D D. all of the above

C 3. The transition to electric cars is not faced with the problem of:

A. ingredients for electric motors and batteries ✓ C. vehicle factories

B. electricity grids ✓

D. All of the above

Instruction 4: Identify the words or phrases which the following words or phrases refer to, and write the answers in the spaces provided, (1 mark each).

1. "there" (para.1) refers to In South Africa
2. "their" (para.1) refers to Electric cars (Neodymium and rare earths)
3. "vital components and elements" (para.3) refers to Lithium, cobalt and rare earths as well as silicon chips
4. "they" (para.5) refers to Batteries
5. "this prediction" (para.4) refers to Analysts' expectation
6. "this area" (para.8) refers to availability of clean renewable electricity insufficient amount
7. "it" (para.9) refers to Progress

Instruction 5: Find words or phrases from the passage that have the same meaning as the following words or phrases, (1 mark each).

1. disappointment (par.2) embarrassment
2. sharp rise (para.3) Yasny increased
3. unsolvable (para.3) insurmountable
4. installed (para.8) deployed
5. obstacle (para.9) impediment
6. discovery (para.5) technological breakthrough
7. exchanging (para.7) swapping
8. convoy (para.1) Purchase
9. discourage (para.4) deter
10. beginning (para.6) down

Instruction 6: Vocabulary from the course module: Complete the following paragraph by filling in the most appropriate word in each blank space. Change each word into its correct grammatical form where necessary. (1 mark each)

coexist ③ grassroots ① plummet ② inevitable ⑥ insidious
 discord ⑦ rampant afflict ⑤ aggravate ④ indigenous ③

In many parts of the world, traditional ways of life are faced with unprecedented existential challenges. People at the ① grassroots are particularly affected by the deteriorating state of the natural environment. Recently, the size of vegetation cover, especially forest reserves has decreased dramatically. In the last couple of decades alone, owing to the deforestation that occurred in search of more farm land, the size of the natural forest reserve has ② plummeted that there is only a negligible amount remaining. ③ Indigenous communities are particularly affected by deforestation. In some places, traditional communities and new settlers are in a state of perennial conflict, and the ④ aggravate between them is growing ever more serious. The once sporadic conflicts have now become very ⑤ insidious. Some among new settlers move with an ⑥ inevitable plan to destabilize traditional communities, and as a result of this, sooner or later, a major conflict is ⑦ discorded. Traditional communities have already been ⑧ afflicted by such conflicts before. They are very poor people who have nothing except their natural habitat - the forests. Unless local governments take timely action, the conflict between the traditional communities and the new settlers maybe ⑨ rampant. Hence, concerned bodies should design policy measures that enable the traditional communities to ⑩ coexist peacefully with the settlers.

Instruction 7: Choose the alternative that completes each sentence correctly, and write your answers in the spaces provided (1 mark each).

- ~~could~~ 1. The professor is eighty-five, but he (~~could~~/may/must) still read and write without glasses.
- ~~might~~ 2. It's very cold today. Do you think it (~~should~~/might/must/) snow later?
- ~~ought to~~ 3. The car is signaling that it has run out of fuel. They (~~will~~/ought to/might) have filled the car with petrol before they set off.
- ~~meet~~ 4. My teacher and I agreed to discuss about the assignment. Accordingly, I (~~am meeting~~/will meet/meet) him at 3 p.m. this afternoon.
- ~~are going to celebrate~~ 5. My father and mother (~~will celebrate~~/are going to celebrate/celebrate) their 25th marriage anniversary next week.

Instruction 8: Reported speech: Change the following sentences from Direct Speech into Reported Speech, (1 mark each).

- 8
1. "I went to campus and then to the bank", he said.

He said that he had gone to campus and then to the bank.

2. "What are you doing tomorrow?" he asked.

He wanted to know what I am doing the next day.

3. "Don't move!", the police officer ordered.

The police officer ordered me not to move.

4. "I will come next week", the teacher said.

The teacher said that he would come the following week.

5. "I have just arrived from Addis", the passenger told the police.

The passenger told the police that he had just arrived from Addis.